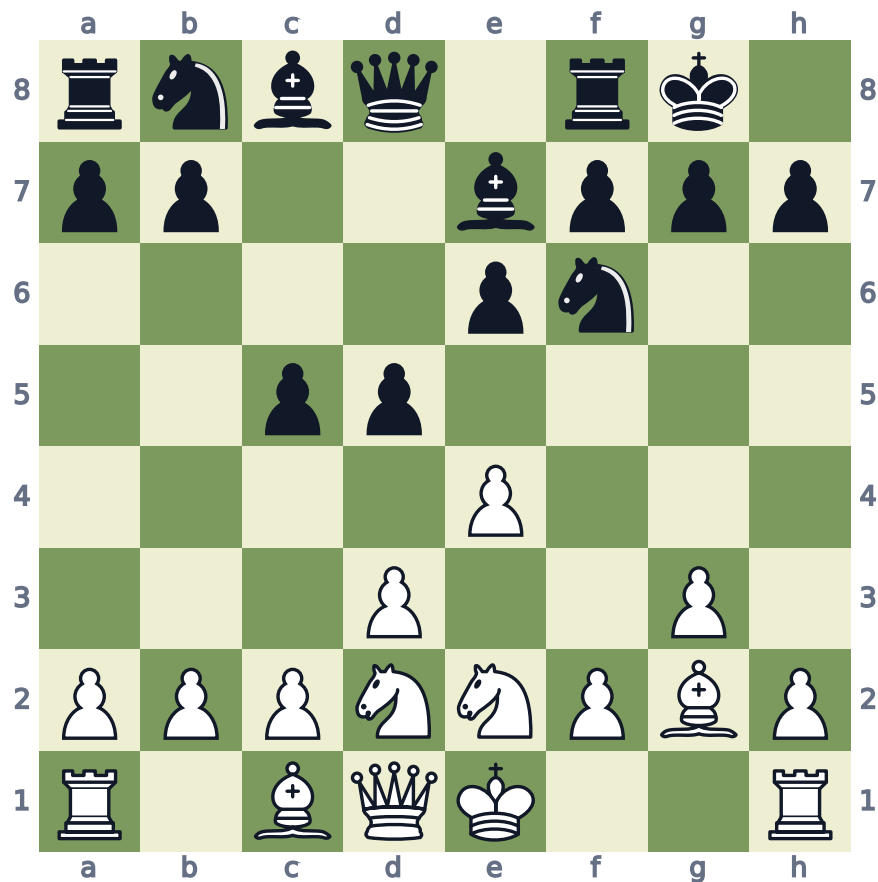


White Hippo vs French, Caro-Kann, and Scandinavian Structures

Compact centers, active bishops, e4 preparation, and timely pawn-chain attacks



Challenge Black's e6, c6, and d5 structures before they become ideal, using White-Hippo move orders that preserve central flexibility.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Challenge Black's e6, c6, and d5 structures before they become ideal, using White-Hippo move orders that preserve central flexibility.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Against e6-d5, e4 and c4 attack different parts of the chain.

PRINCIPLE 2

Against c6-d5, Black may develop the c8 bishop before closing the center.

PRINCIPLE 3

An immediate d5 gives White a clear target but not unlimited time.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

A queenside fianchetto is safe only when the long diagonal is blocked or defended.

PRINCIPLE 5

Exchanges can turn the position into a French, Caro, or Slav structure.

PRINCIPLE 6

The setup's value lies in choosing the favorable transposition.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

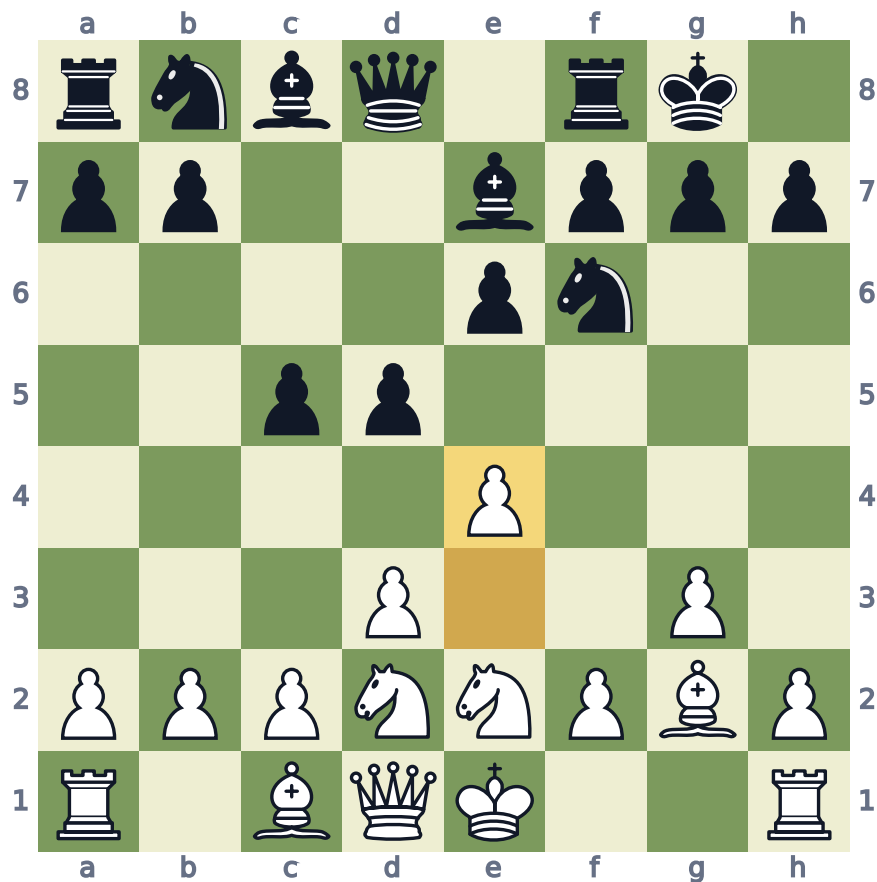
- | | | |
|-----------|--|--|
| 01 | French shell with e4 | Against e6-d5, e4 is useful before Black fixes the chain. |
| 02 | French shell with c4 | Challenge d5 with a flank pawn only when the center remains supported. |
| 03 | Caro shell with e4 | Prepare e4 with pieces, then calculate the exchange. |
| 04 | Caro shell with Black e5 | A Caro move order can become a classical center; follow the pawns. |
| 05 | Scandinavian-style immediate d5 | An immediate d5 is a target, not permission to wait. |
| 06 | d5-c6 compact shell | When c6 supports d5, e4 must be prepared accurately. |
| 07 | d5-e5 transposition with c4 | Use c4 when it opens a file and creates a second break. |
| 08 | Safe queenside fianchetto order | If b6 comes before a blocker, Bxa8 wins the rook. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

French shell with e4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack d5 and transpose toward a King's Indian Attack structure.

MAIN DANGER

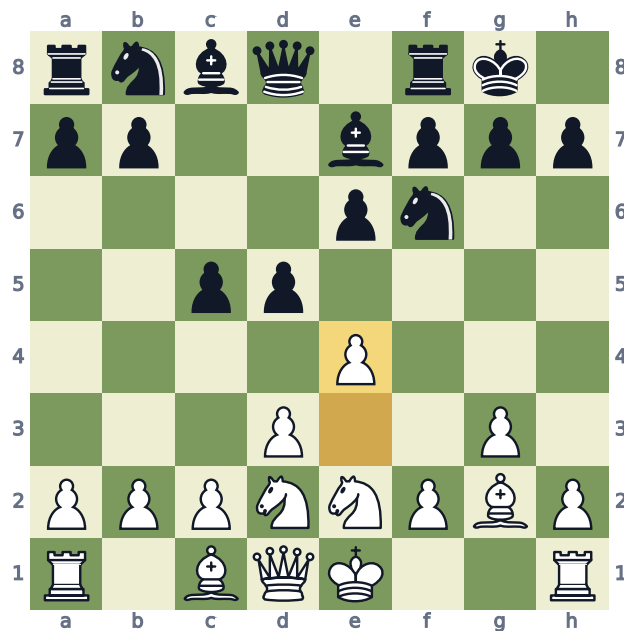
d4 can gain space and close the g2 bishop.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against e6-d5, e4 is useful before Black fixes the chain.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.52 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 exd5 2. exd5 O-O 3. Re8 Nf4 4. Bf8 Nf3 5. h6 h3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

French shell with e4



YOUR TASK

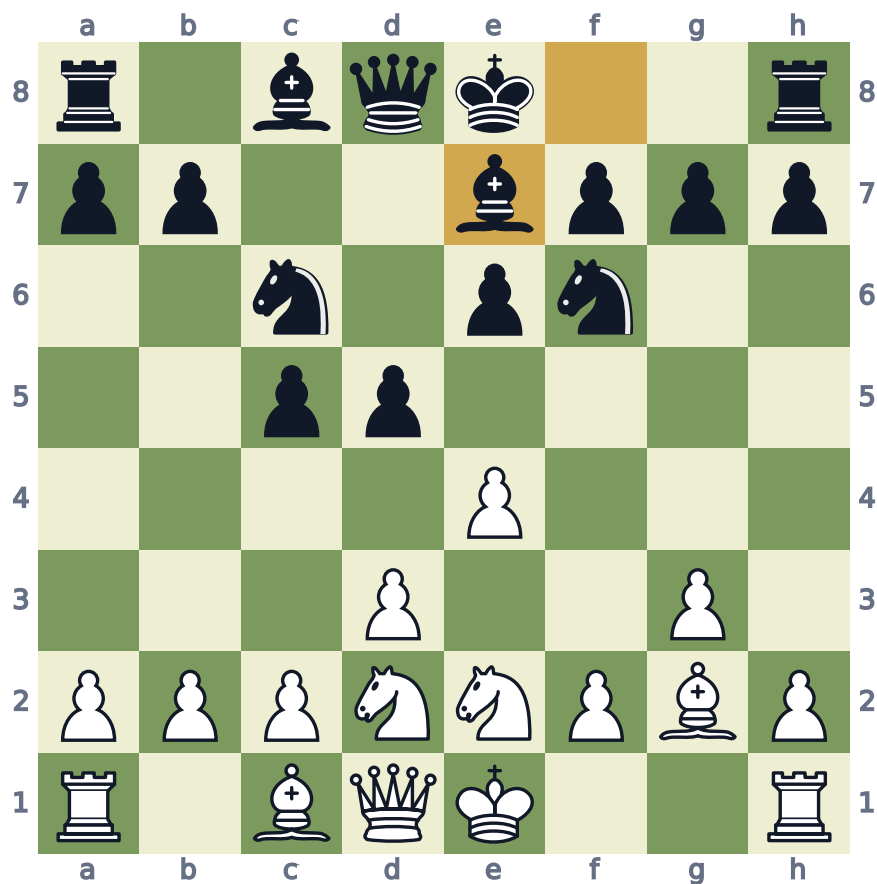
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

French shell with c4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e6 2. Bg2 c5 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nd2 d5 5. e4 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

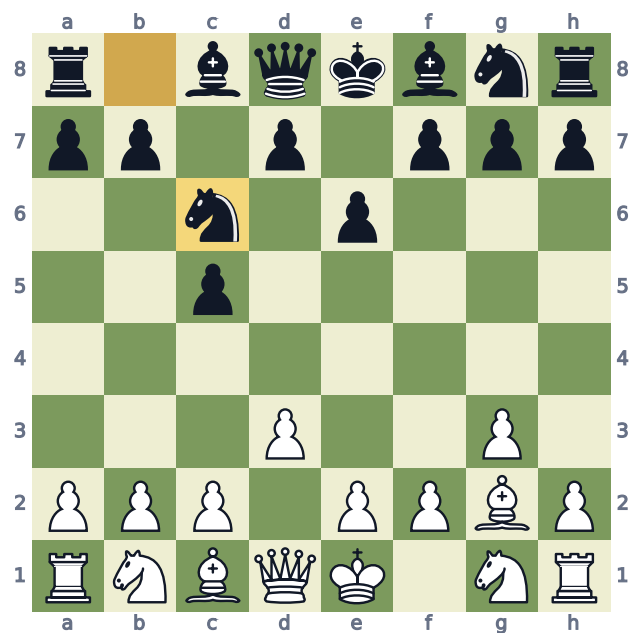
Use e4 and c4 pressure to prevent a free classical center.

MAIN DANGER

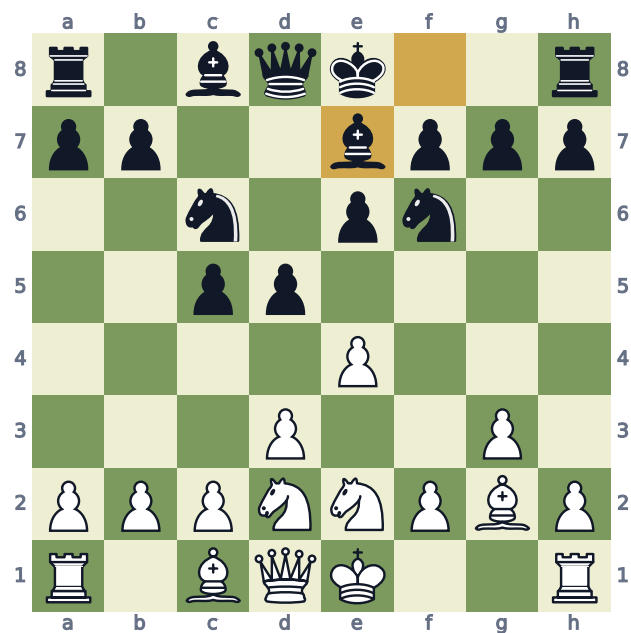
d4 can create a Benoni-like space bind.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Challenge d5 with a flank pawn only when the center remains supported.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

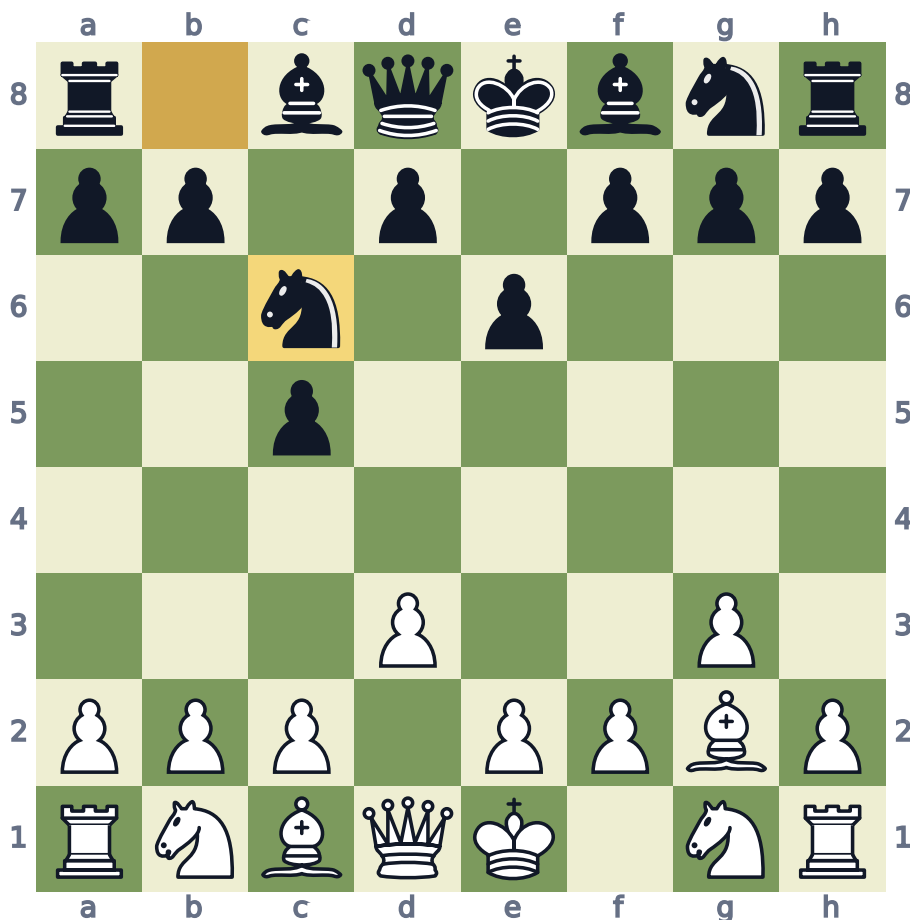
Position estimate: -0.15 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. O-O e5 2. exd5 Nxd5 3. Nc3 Be6 4. Nc4 O-O 5. Re1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

French shell with c4



YOUR TASK

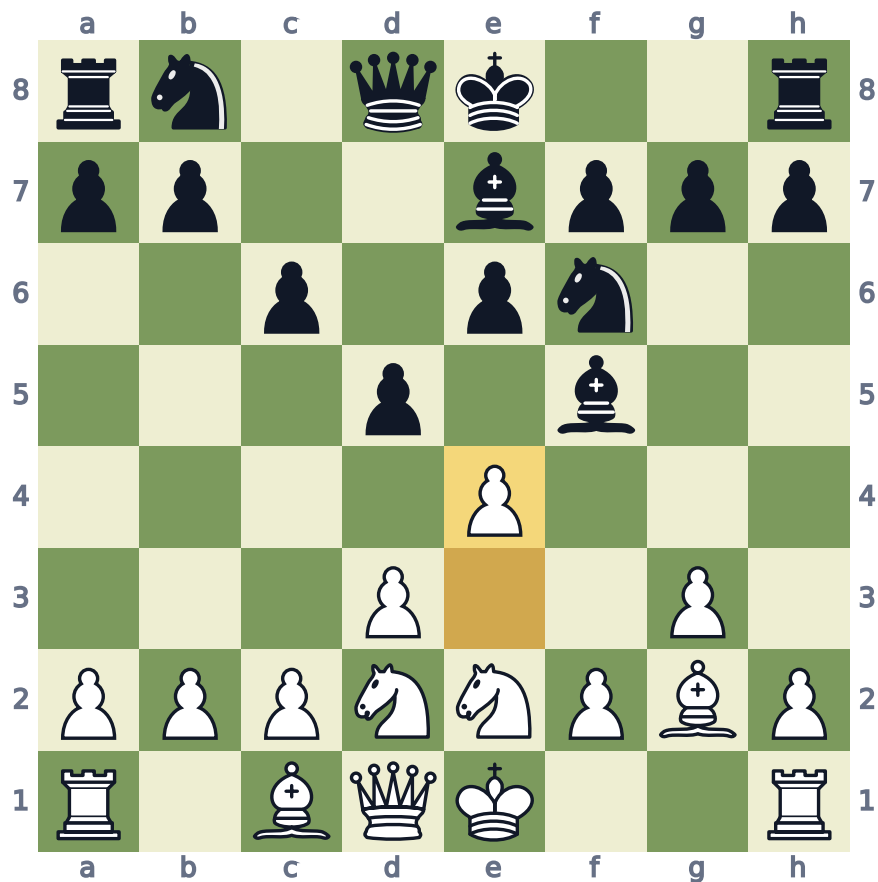
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Caro shell with e4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Bf5 4. Nd2 e6 5. e3 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

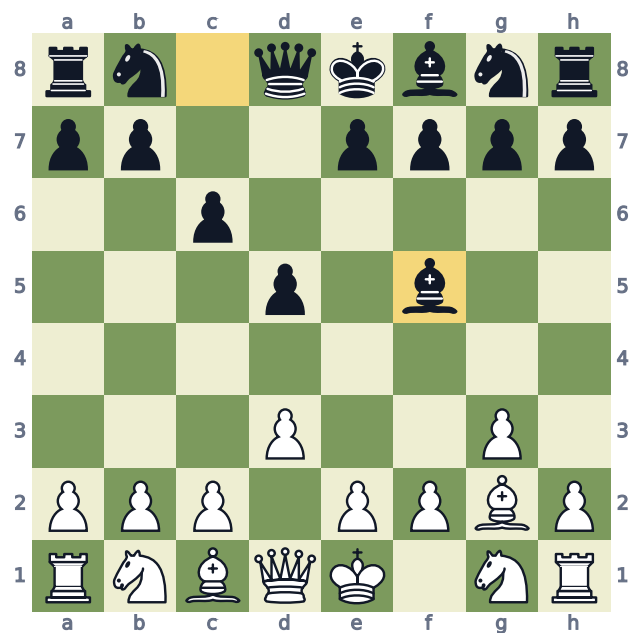
Challenge d5 after Black's bishop leaves the pawn chain.

MAIN DANGER

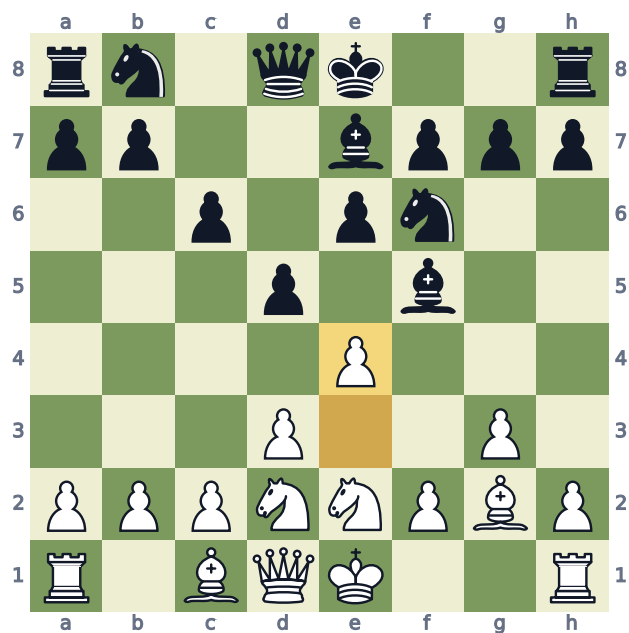
dx e4 can open lines while White is uncastled.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Prepare e4 with pieces, then calculate the exchange.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.63 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg6 Nf4 2. e5 Nxc6 3. hxc6 Qe2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Caro shell with e4



YOUR TASK

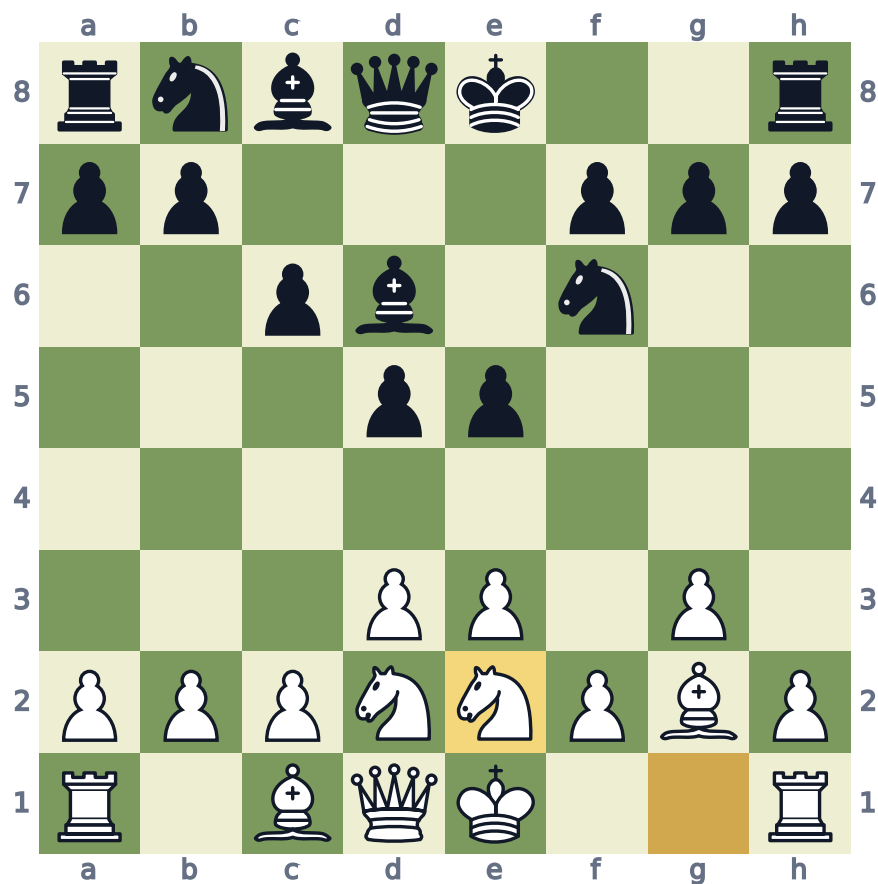
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Caro shell with Black e5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c6 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 Bd6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

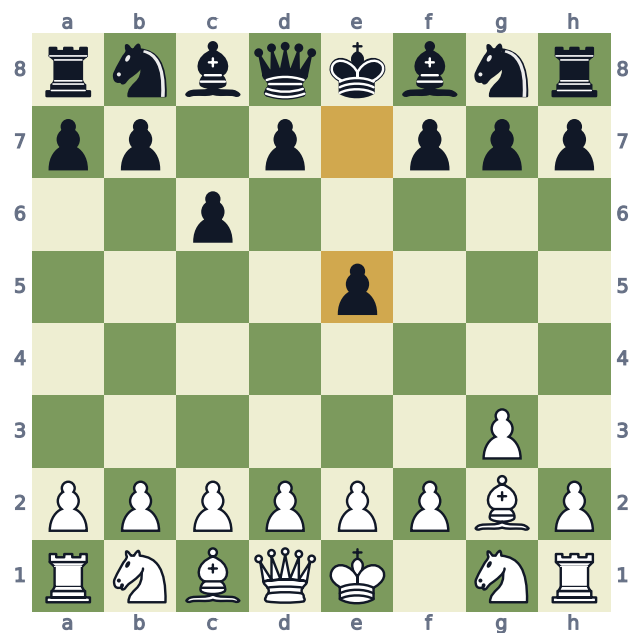
Prepare e4 or c4 against Black's full center.

MAIN DANGER

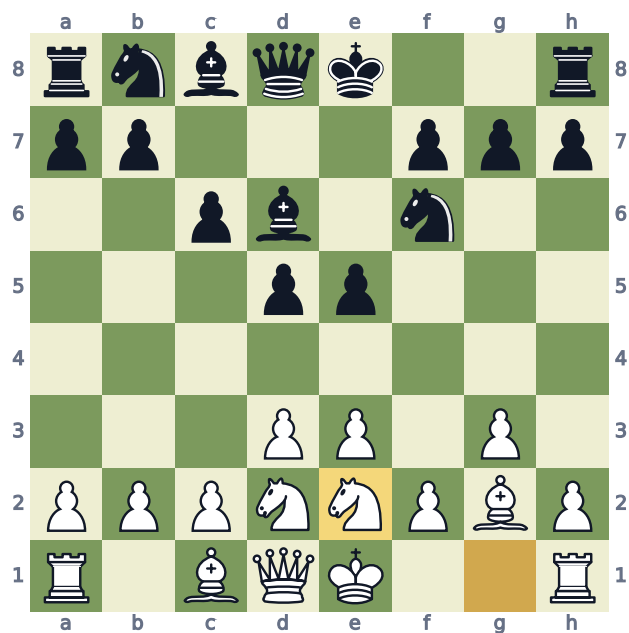
e4 can gain space and restrict Nd2.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A Caro move order can become a classical center; follow the pawns.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

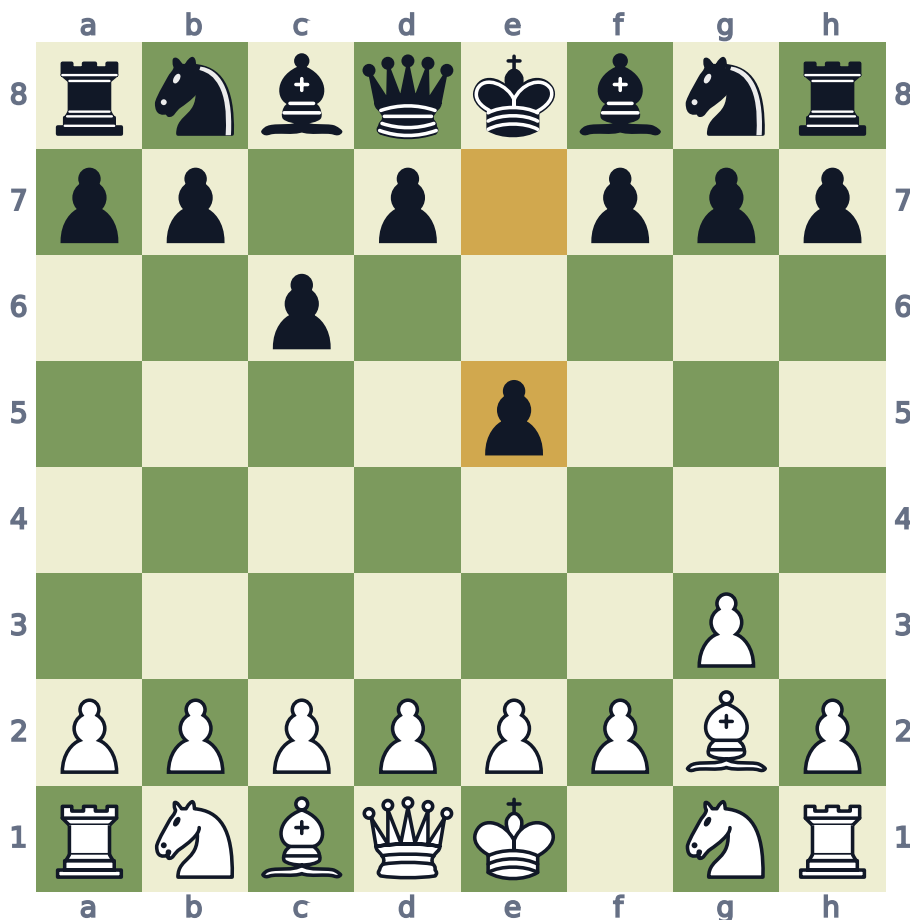
Position estimate: -0.72 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O b3 2. a5 O-O 3. Re8 Bb2 4. Na6 a3 5. h5 h3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Caro shell with Black e5



YOUR TASK

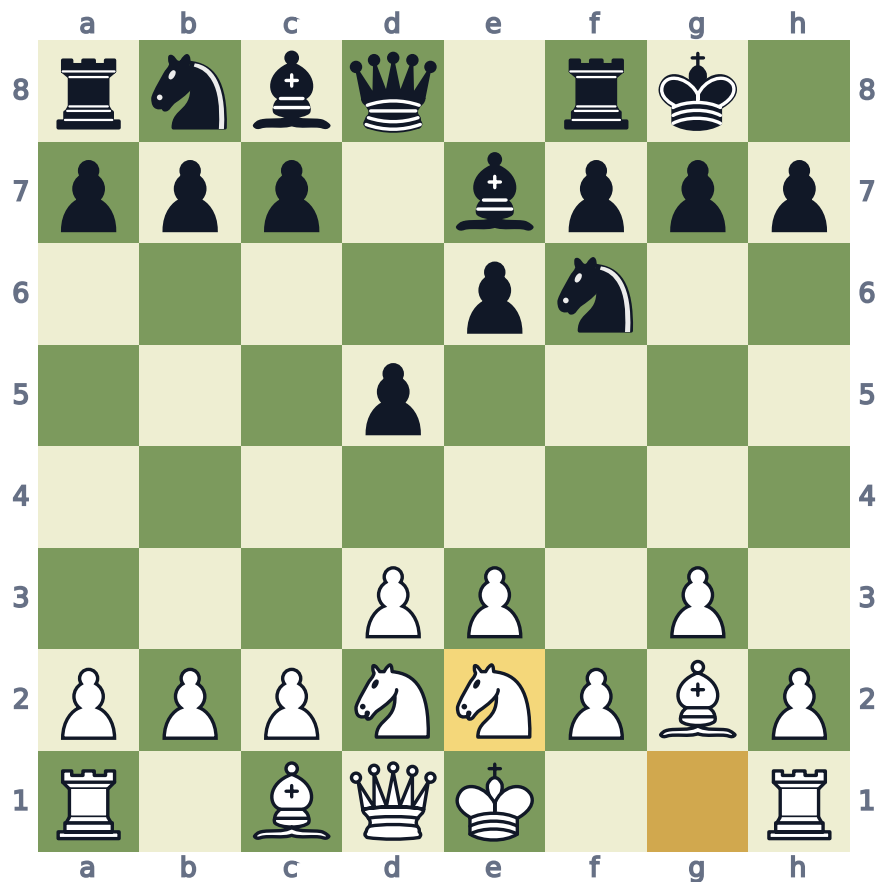
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Scandinavian-style immediate d5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 e6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

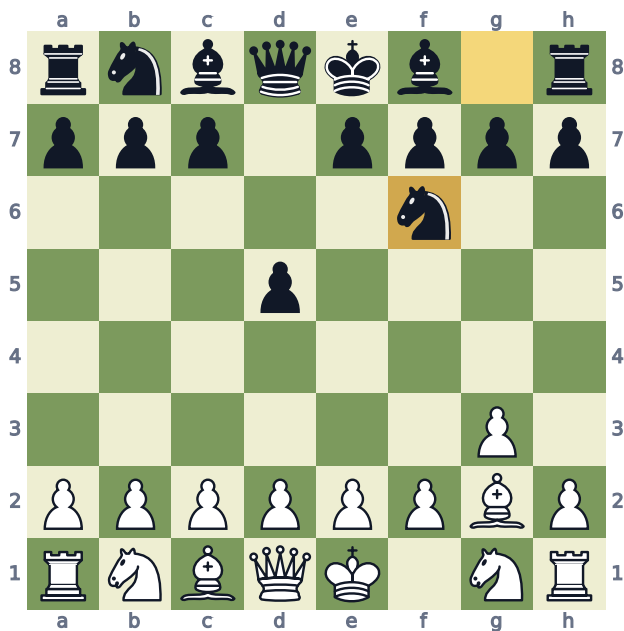
Prepare e4 or c4 while Black's center is still modest.

MAIN DANGER

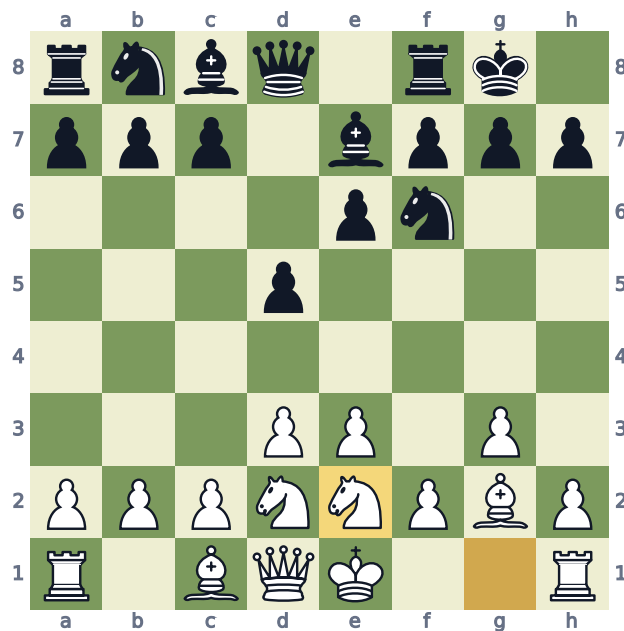
d4 can close the position on Black's terms.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

An immediate d5 is a target, not permission to wait.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.36 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c5 O-O 2. b6 b3 3. Bb7 c4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Scandinavian-style immediate d5



YOUR TASK

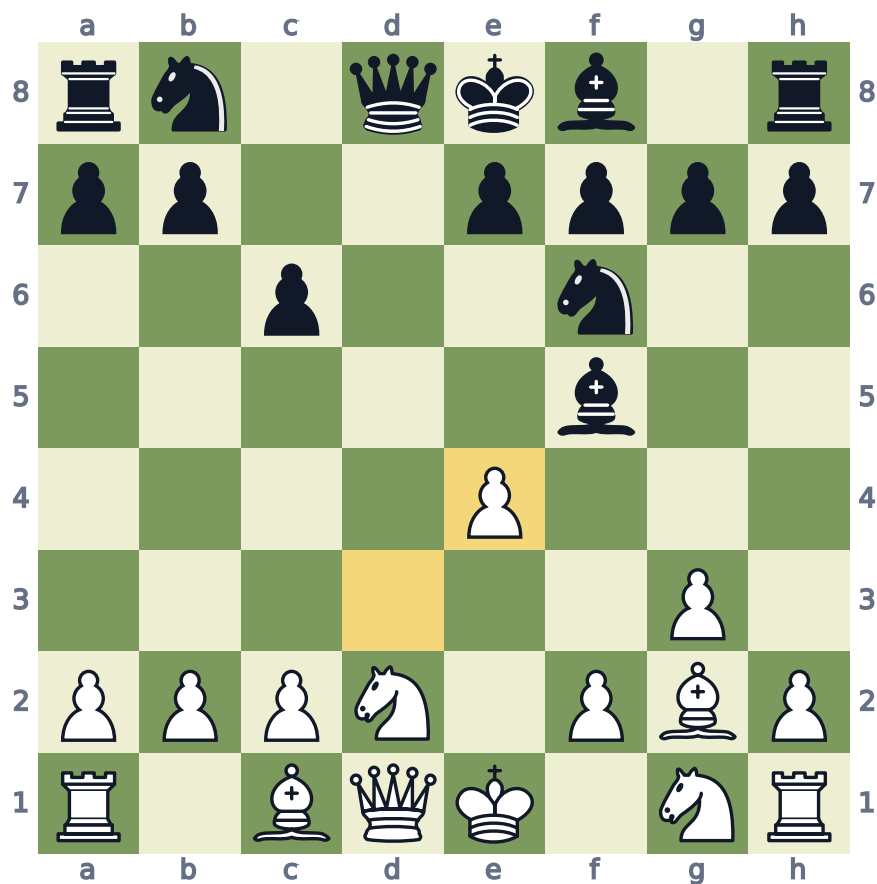
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

d5-c6 compact shell



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 c6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Bf5 5. e4 dxe4 6. dxe4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

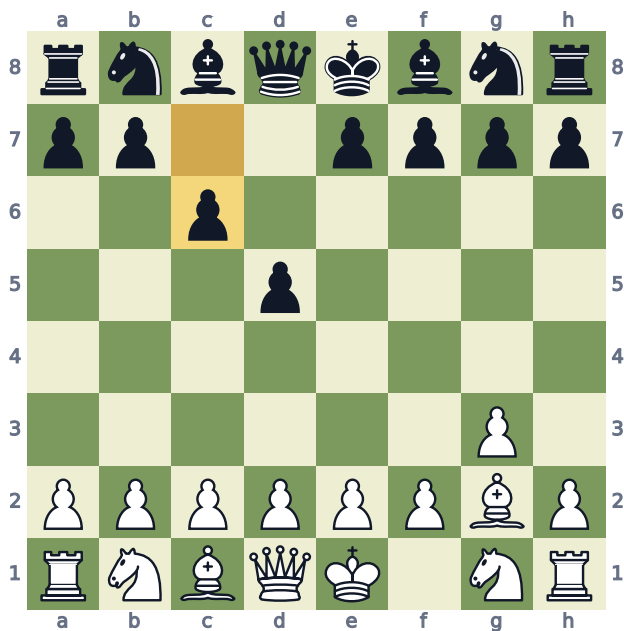
Use e4 to force central clarification and open development lines.

MAIN DANGER

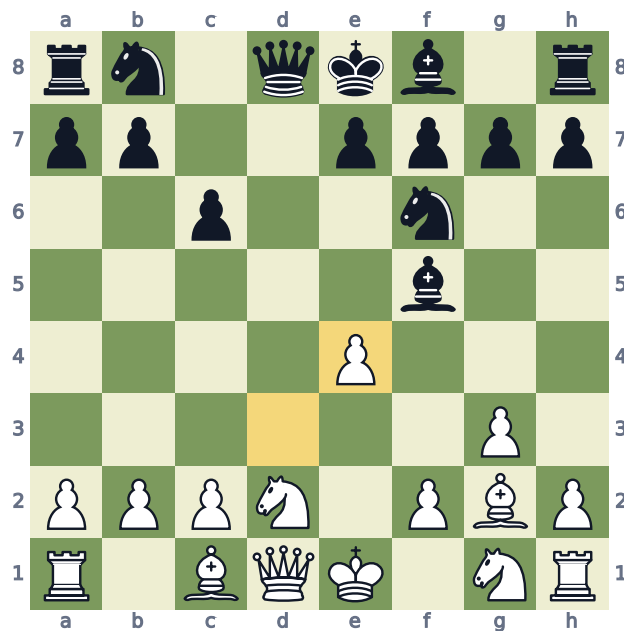
Bg4 can pin the queen or knight after exchanges.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When c6 supports d5, e4 must be prepared accurately.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

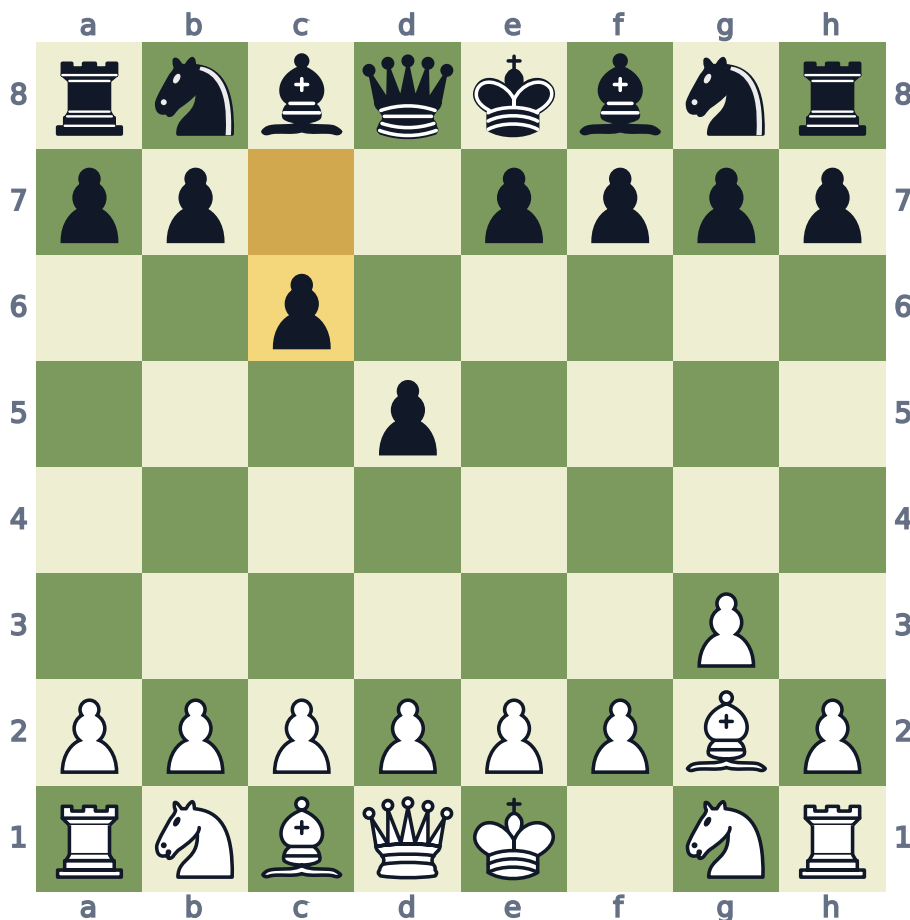
Position estimate: +0.74 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg4 Ngf3 2. e5 h3 3. Bxf3 Qxf3 4. Bc5 Nc4 5. Nbd7 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

d5-c6 compact shell



YOUR TASK

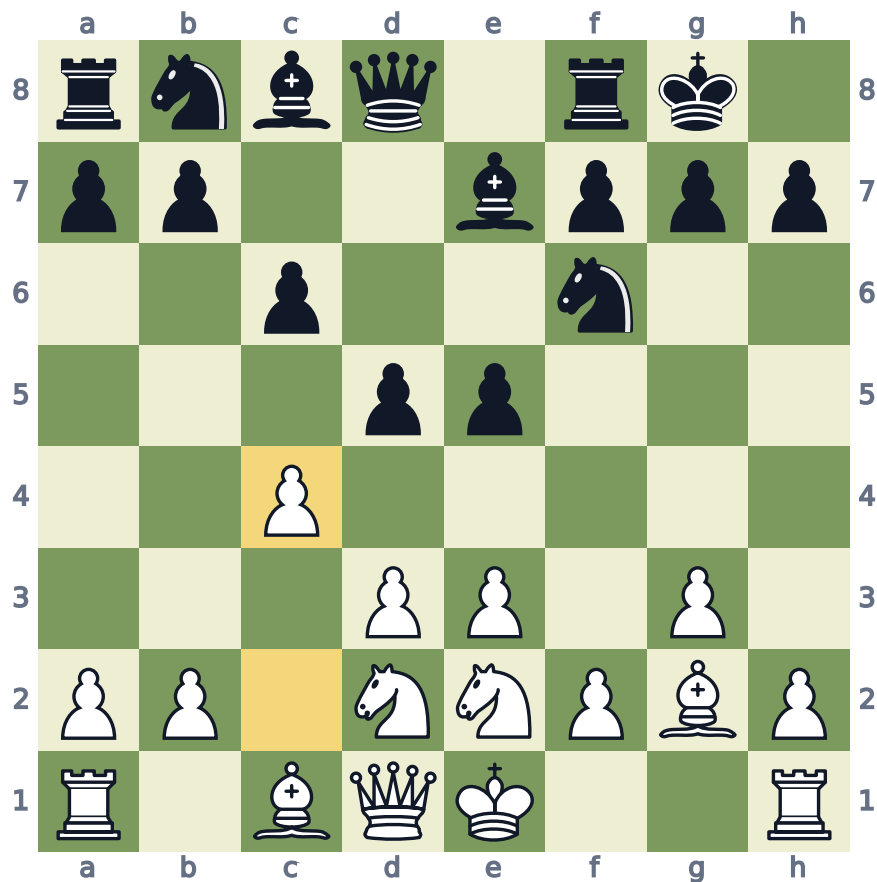
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

d5-e5 transposition with c4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. c4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack d5 before Black closes the center completely.

MAIN DANGER

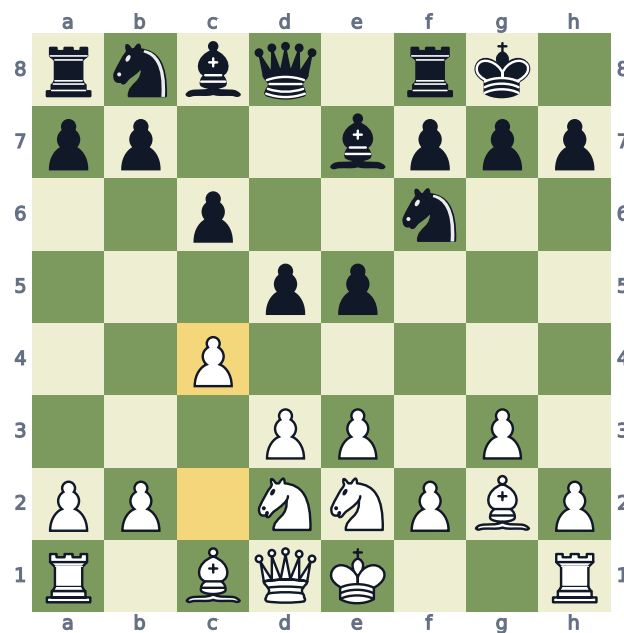
d4 may gain space and make c4 a target.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Use c4 when it opens a file and creates a second break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.05 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bf5 e4 2. dxe4 dxe4 3. Be6 O-O 4. Na6 a3 5. Nc5 Qc2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

d5-e5 transposition with c4



YOUR TASK

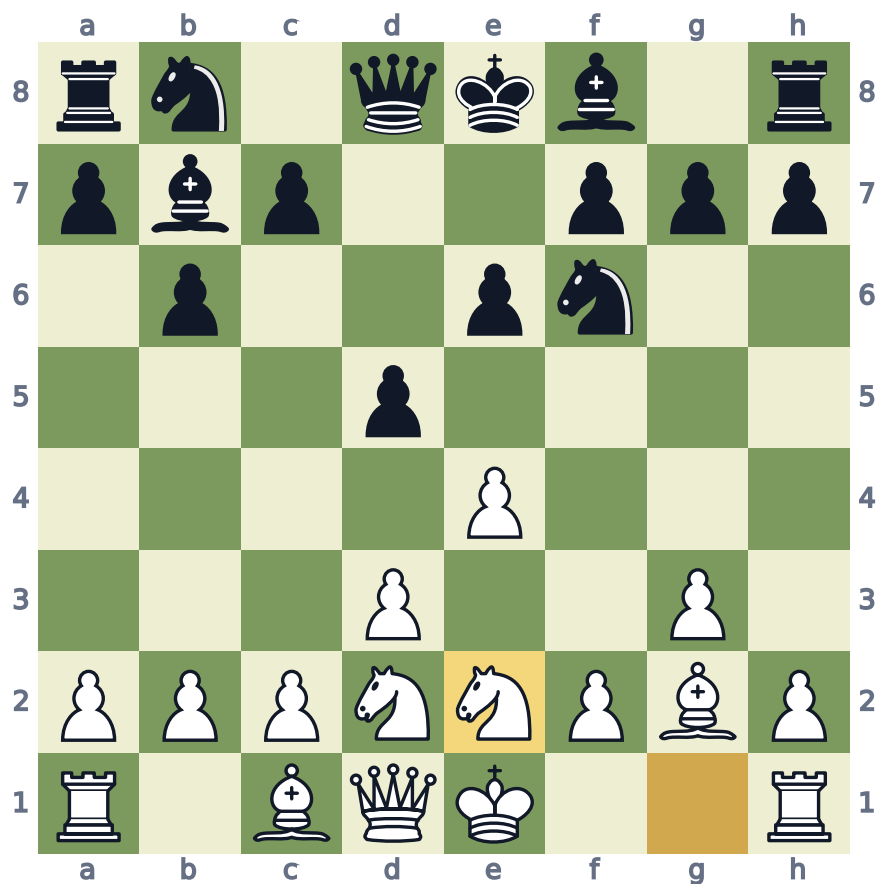
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Safe queenside fianchetto order



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 b6 4. Nd2 Bb7 5. e4 Nf6 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

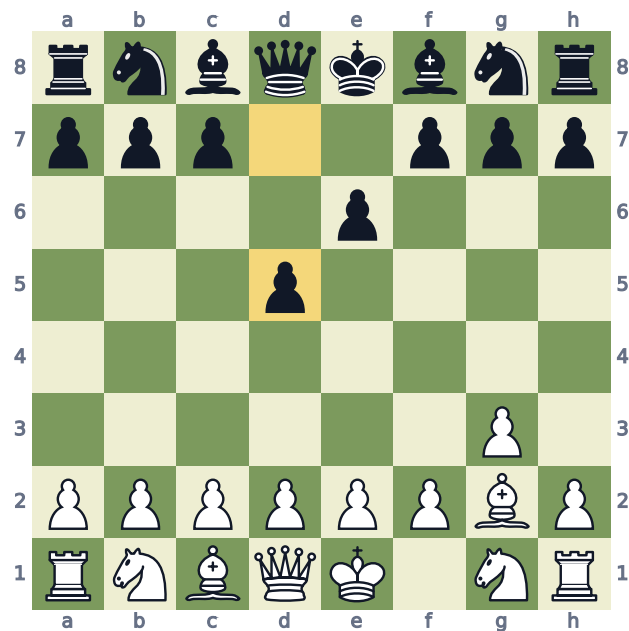
Use d5 to block the a8 diagonal before Black plays b6 and Bb7.

MAIN DANGER

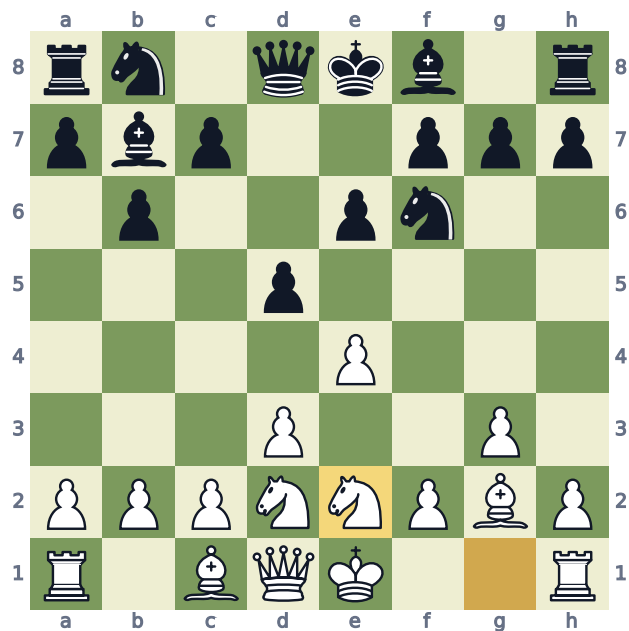
dxe4 can open the bishop with tempo.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

If b6 comes before a blocker, Bxa8 wins the rook.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

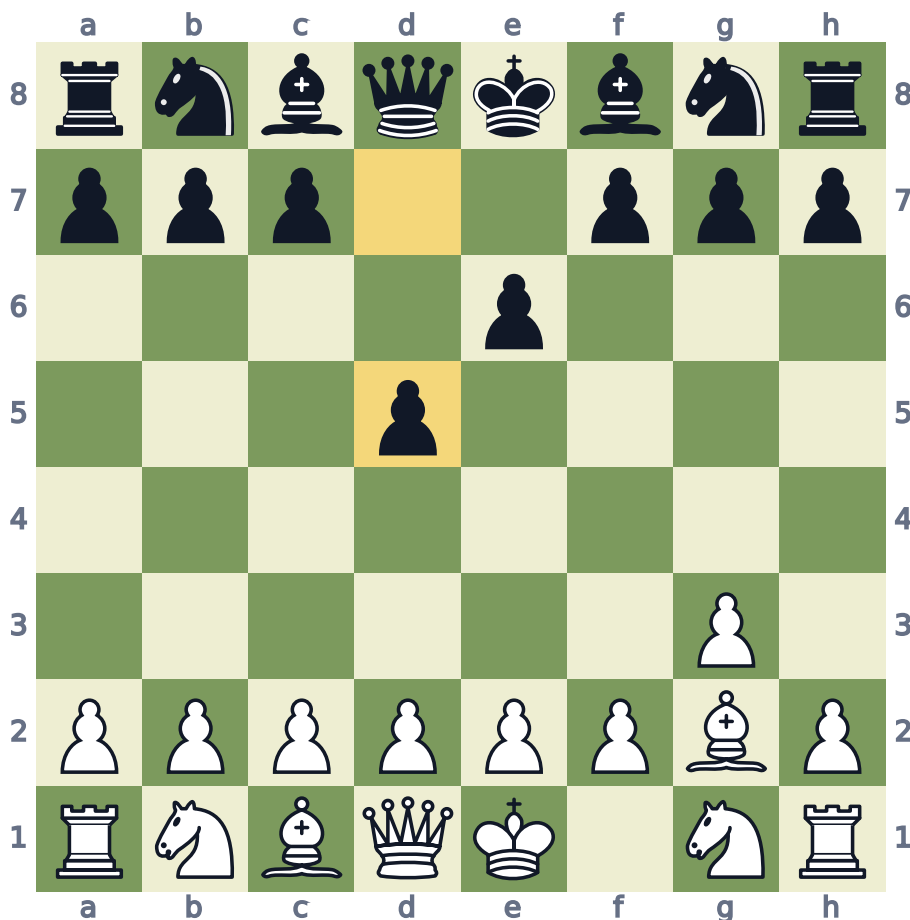
Position estimate: -0.26 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. dxe4 O-O 2. Nc6 Nxe4 3. Nxe4 dxe4 4. Qxd1 Rxd1 5. Bd6 Nc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Safe queenside fianchetto order



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. FRENCH SHELL WITH E4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Attack d5 and transpose toward a King's Indian Attack structure. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O a5 3. c4 O-O 4. Bf4 h6 5. Re1 (+0.01 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 can gain space and close the g2 bishop.

02. FRENCH SHELL WITH C4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use e4 and c4 pressure to prevent a free classical center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 d5 2. O-O Bd6 3. c4 d4 4. e3 e5 5. exd4 cxd4 (+0.17 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 can create a Benoni-like space bind.

03. CARO SHELL WITH E4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge d5 after Black's bishop leaves the pawn chain. Engine comparison: 1. Nd2 e5 2. Ngf3 Nd7 3. e4 dxe4 4. dxe4 Be6 5. Qe2 Bc5 (+0.45 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: dxe4 can open lines while White is uncastled.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. CARO SHELL WITH BLACK E5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 against Black's full center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 e4 2. Nd4 d5 3. d3 exd3 4. Qxd3 Bc5 5. Nb3 Bb6 (+0.31 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can gain space and restrict Nd2.

05. SCANDINAVIAN-STYLE IMMEDIATE D5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 while Black's center is still modest. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 g6 2. c4 c6 3. b3 Bg7 4. Bb2 Bg4 5. d4 Nbd7 (+0.31 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close the position on Black's terms.

06. D5-C6 COMPACT SHELL

Course move: d3. Purpose: Use e4 to force central clarification and open development lines. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 g6 2. O-O Bg7 3. d4 Nf6 4. b3 Bf5 5. Bb2 O-O (+0.22 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Bg4 can pin the queen or knight after exchanges.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. D5-E5 TRANSPOSITION WITH C4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Attack d5 before Black closes the center completely. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 may gain space and make c4 a target.

08. SAFE QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO ORDER

Course move: d3. Purpose: Use d5 to block the a8 diagonal before Black plays b6 and Bb7. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d4 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. O-O c5 4. e3 Nc6 5. d3 Be7 (+0.46 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: dxe4 can open the bishop with tempo.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.